

MARKETING SWEET · SALES TRAINING

Practice Scenarios — Roleplay Briefs

14 prospect briefs, organised by session. Two reps per scenario. One plays the prospect from the brief; the other handles the conversation ad-lib. Run, debrief, swap, run again.

How to use these

1. Pick a scenario.
2. The “prospect rep” reads the brief and commits to the role — the prospect’s mood, business, position. Use the **what to expect** list as your script of moves, but improvise the dialogue.
3. The “rep” handles the conversation cold — no script. Apply the technique from the linked session.
4. Run for 5–10 minutes.
5. Pause and debrief using the prompts at the bottom.
6. Swap roles. Run again with a slightly different twist.

The scenarios are deliberately briefer than the seven scripted roleplays — these are *practice cards*, not *examples*. The goal is to build reflex, not to memorise lines.

Session 01 — Pitch High, Show the Stack

Scenario 1A — “I need to think about it”

Difficulty: Intermediate · **Run time:** ~10 min

The prospect. Mark Henderson. Owns *Henderson Stone & Tile* — 6 staff, residential tiling. 14 years in business. ~\$1.4M turnover. His current website is functional but ranks for nothing.

The mood. Friendly throughout the meeting. Asked good questions. Seemed engaged with the three-website demo. Then, after you named the price (\$8,500), he said the line: *“Yeah, look, it sounds great. I’m definitely interested. I’ll just need to think about it overnight and get back to you tomorrow.”*

Where you are now. End of the meeting. He’s not signing today. The technique from Session 01 is the diagnostic — *“I need to think”* almost always means one of three things: **price**, **trust** (you said something off), or **partner/spouse approval**.

The rep’s job. Run the diagnostic. Surface which of the three this actually is, without becoming pushy. Then handle it.

What to expect from Mark. - He’ll resist naming the real reason at first — “just want to sleep on it” - If asked about price, he’ll likely admit it’s borderline for him - If asked about his wife/partner, he’ll acknowledge that she’s involved in big decisions - He’s not a trust-failure prospect — you didn’t make any mistakes

Success looks like. The rep surfaces price OR partner approval as the real driver, then runs the right play. Reverses the timeline (“you said tomorrow, I’ll give you Friday — let’s book the follow-up now”). Books a specific next call before the meeting ends.

Debrief prompts. - Did the rep diagnose, or just accept “let me think”? - Did they book a specific next contact, or leave it open? - If price was the real driver, did they panic-discount?

Scenario 1B — Negotiating to \$825

Difficulty: Easy · **Run time:** ~8 min

The prospect. Linda Ashcroft. Owns *Ashcroft Beauty* (small day spa, 2 staff). She's been told her website needs work. You've pitched her a \$1,200 site rebuild. She's keen — but she's a sharp negotiator and wants a number that "feels right."

The mood. Friendly but firm. Says she's keen to go ahead — but at \$800. *"Round number. Easy."*

Where you are now. You've decided \$1,200 is too high to land but you can probably get the office to approve \$825 if she signs today.

The rep's job. Apply Session 01's odd-number close. \$825 with the "best I could do, sorry I couldn't quite get there" tone — NOT \$800. The tone matters as much as the number.

What to expect from Linda. - She'll push for \$800 first ("come on, round it down") - If you fold to \$800, she'll try for \$750 next - If you hold at \$825 with the right tone, she'll sign

Success looks like. The rep names \$825 (not \$800), delivers the line with slight regret (not triumph), holds the number when she pushes for \$800, gets her to sign at \$825.

Debrief prompts. - Did the rep use the odd number, or default to a round one? - What was the rep's tone — triumphant, casual, or slightly regretful? - Did they fold under one more push, or hold?

Session 02 — Big Energy, Better Research, Stop Hunting Excuses

Scenario 2A — The unprepared ambush

Difficulty: Hard · **Run time:** ~10 min

The prospect. Trevor Whitford. Owns *Whitford Excavations* — 9 staff, civil contracting. ~\$3M turnover, 25 years in business. Sharp operator, knows his numbers, hates time-wasters.

The mood. Polite-skeptical. He's let you in but he's testing whether you're worth his hour.

Where you are now. Five minutes into the meeting. Trevor cuts you off mid-sentence: *"Alright mate, before we go any further — quick question. What's my monthly turnover? You should know that if you're here."*

The rep's job. This is the Session 02 preparation test. If the rep walked in without their 5 P's homework done, they need to handle this in a way that doesn't blow the credibility entirely. If they did the prep, they should be able to give the number confidently within a 10–20% band — and turn the moment into a connection win.

What to expect from Trevor. - He'll wait silently for the rep to answer — no rescue - If they fumble: he'll be polite but visibly write them off ("alright then, let's continue") - If they nail the number: he'll look surprised and the meeting tone shifts dramatically - He'll follow up with: "Why do you think that?" — testing the methodology, not just the answer

Success looks like. The rep delivers an estimate around \$300k–\$400k/month (9 staff × \$100k × ~3x for civil/trade = \$2.7M annual / 12 = ~\$225k floor, with high end ~\$400k). They explain the trade-business multiplier briefly and confidently. They turn the moment into rapport, not defensiveness.

Debrief prompts. - Did the rep deliver a number with confidence, or hedge? - Did they apply the trade-business multiplier (×3) correctly? - If they didn't have the prep, did they cover gracefully or panic?

Scenario 2B — Soft-vocabulary coaching

Difficulty: Easy · **Run time:** ~10 min · **Reps required:** 2 (peer coaching)

The setup. This is internal — one rep coaches another on power-word substitution.

Rep A has just come off a call with a prospect (booking confirmation for next week). Rep B was listening in.

The mood. Casual but coaching-focused. No prospect.

Where you are now. Rep A's call had a lot of 7-out-of-10 vocabulary: "*sounds good*", "*that's great*", "*no worries*", "*yeah ok*", "*have a good one mate*". Rep B's job is to call it out — without being a dick about it — and drill the substitutions.

The rep's job (Rep B). Replay the soft words back with concrete alternatives: - "sounds good" → "perfect" / "amazing" - "great" → "superb opportunity" - "yeah ok" → "perfect — let's go" - "no worries" → cut entirely, use "of course" or "absolutely"

Then Rep A re-runs the same call in 60 seconds with the upgraded vocab. Rep B grades it.

What to expect from Rep A. - Initial defensiveness ("it's just how I talk") - Awkward overuse of "perfect" on the first re-run - By round three, it starts to sound natural

Success looks like. Rep A finishes the drill with at least 4 of the 7/10 words replaced reflexively, without thinking. The re-run sounds noticeably more energetic.

Debrief prompts. - Which power-words felt forced, which felt natural? - Did Rep B call out without making it personal? - What's Rep A's one word to drill out of their vocab this week?

Session 03 — Obsession is the Multiplier, Balance is the Scam

Scenario 3A — Peer accountability

Difficulty: Hard · **Run time:** ~15 min · **Reps required:** 2 peers

The setup. Two senior reps catching up over coffee. **Rep A** has noticed **Rep B** drifting — coming in late, prep slipping, fewer second meetings. Rep A likes Rep B and doesn't want a confrontation, but the operator-handover from Session 03 means it's now Rep A's job to have the conversation. Not Corie's.

The mood. Friendly. Coffee at the start. Rep A needs to shift it without nuking the friendship.

Where you are now. Coffee's poured. The chat needs to start.

The rep's job (Rep A). Apply the peer accountability frame from Session 03. Lead with what you've noticed. Don't make it about feelings. Don't apologise for raising it. Land on a specific behaviour Rep B will change, and how you'll know.

What to expect from Rep B. - Initial deflection ("yeah it's been a tough month") - An external excuse (leads, family, illness, whatever) - Eventually — if pushed gently — the honest answer ("yeah, got comfortable") - Some resistance to being held accountable by a peer specifically ("you're not my manager")

Success looks like. Rep A surfaces the drift without losing the friendship. Rep B commits to one specific habit change and an accountability mechanism. The conversation ends warm but with a clear bar.

Debrief prompts. - Did Rep A wait for permission, or open the conversation? - Did they refuse the external excuses politely, or accept them? - Did they end with a *specific* commitment, or a vague one?

Scenario 3B — Solo self-reflection after a lost deal

Difficulty: Intermediate · **Run time:** ~10 min · **Reps required:** 1 (solo or with witness)

The setup. A rep has just lost a deal they expected to close. The prospect was *Davidson Roofing* — 8 staff, \$2M turnover, perfect fit on paper. Three meetings. Strong rapport. Rep felt confident. Then today: “*We’ve decided to go with someone else.*”

The mood. Rep is gutted. Wants to vent. The session 03 discipline is to refuse the vent and force the reflection.

Where you are now. Five minutes after the no. Rep sits down to write the post-mortem.

The rep’s job. Apply the Session 03 post-loss discipline: - No external excuses (market, leads, competitors) - One specific thing about *their own behaviour* that they’d change - One concrete habit installed this week as a result

Write three sentences max. No more.

What to expect from the rep (themselves). - Brain will offer reasons first (“the competitor undercut me”, “they were tyre-kickers anyway”, “the budget changed”) - Honest answer is harder to land — has to be about something they did or didn’t do - Common honest answers: not enough connection in meeting 2; didn’t ask about the partner/decision-maker; let price come up before value was established

Success looks like. Three sentences written. No external blame. One specific behaviour change. One concrete habit for this week.

Debrief prompts (if done with a witness). - Were any sentences masking an excuse? - Is the behaviour change specific enough to do, or is it vague (“be better”)? - Is the habit installable this week, or is it aspirational?

Session 04 — Rock Solid is the Energy, Say It Then Deliver It

Scenario 4A — Discount request without verbal commit

Difficulty: Intermediate · **Run time:** ~10 min

The prospect. Kane Whitlam. Owns *Whitlam Building Group* — 18 staff, residential builds. ~\$5M turnover. Has been pitched the \$14,000 SEO + content + landing pages package. Likes the pitch. Wants a discount.

The mood. Friendly but trying to extract a price drop. Knows enough to ask but not enough to know how he'll be tested.

Where you are now. Mid-pitch, Kane says: *"Look, the scope's good, but \$14k is hard for me right now. Can you do \$11k?"*

The rep's job. Session 04 / 06 rule — before going back to the office or fighting on price, get the verbal commit. *"If I can get you to a better number, are you signing today?"* Without that, any number you give him is just a negotiation floor.

What to expect from Kane. - He'll dodge the verbal commit first: *"Well, I need to think about it anyway"* - If pushed gently, he'll either confirm ("yeah if you can do \$11.5k I'll sign now") or expose that he wasn't actually closing today - If he confirms, rep should hold at \$12,250 (odd number) — not \$11k - If he wouldn't have signed today regardless, rep should hold at \$14k and address the real objection

Success looks like. The rep extracts a clear verbal commit before negotiating, holds at a defensible odd number, doesn't go back to the office without the commit in hand.

Debrief prompts. - Did the rep ask the verbal commit question, or jump to negotiation? - Did they accept "I need to think anyway" as a stall, or call it out? - What number did they land on, and was it round or odd?

Scenario 4B — The Monday close-out

Difficulty: Easy · **Run time:** ~5 min

The prospect. Vinh Tran. Owns *Tran Tiling*. Was quoted \$7,500. You said *“If we lock this in by Friday close, I can hold this number. After Friday it goes back to standard rate.”* It’s now Monday morning. Vinh didn’t reply Friday. Didn’t reply over the weekend.

The mood. Vinh’s a hard-to-read operator. You don’t know if he’s a real prospect or a time-waster who used you for a price quote.

Where you are now. Sitting at your desk Monday 9am, drafting the email.

The rep’s job. Session 04 — hold the deadline. Send ONE professional close-out message. Don’t chase. Don’t re-offer. Don’t soften.

The email should: - Acknowledge the missed Friday deadline calmly - Confirm the \$7,500 is off the table - Leave the door open at the standard rate - Wish him well, no pressure - Under 80 words

What to expect from Vinh (downstream). - ~40% chance he comes back at full rate — real prospect who just got busy - ~30% chance he comes back at the \$7,500 trying to negotiate — rep should hold (deadline-broken means the price stays at standard) - ~30% chance he doesn’t come back — that’s fine

Success looks like. The email is short, doesn’t apologise, doesn’t reopen, but doesn’t burn the bridge. Reads like a confident professional moving on.

Debrief prompts. - Did the rep apologise for the deadline (“sorry to bother you”)? - Did they try to extend or re-soften the offer? - Is the email under 80 words?

Session 05 — Discipline is the Multiplier, You're the Operator Now

Scenario 5A — Partner approval timeline reversal

Difficulty: Intermediate · **Run time:** ~10 min

The prospect. Karina Boroski. Owns *Boroski Painting & Decorating* with her husband Matt. 5 staff. ~\$900k turnover. She's the front-of-house, he's on the tools.

The mood. Engaged, enthusiastic, ready to say yes. But she always involves Matt on big decisions.

Where you are now. End of the meeting. She's nodding along to the pitch (\$6,200 website + SEO bundle). When you start moving to the close:

"This sounds amazing. I just need to run it past Matt — he's at a job site until late tonight. Can I get back to you by end of week?"

The rep's job. Apply Session 05 — partner approval is a buying signal, not an objection. Reverse the timeline (she asked for end of week, you give her four days). Reassure. Book the next contact specifically before she leaves. Give her your direct number so Matt can call.

What to expect from Karina. - She'll resist a same-day commitment ("Matt's really hard to get hold of today") - She'll accept four days easily because it's MORE time than she asked for - She might ask whether Matt can call you — say yes, give the number - She'll likely close on the next call (~80% of these do, per the session)

Success looks like. Rep reverses the timeline, books a specific follow-up time/day with Karina before she leaves, gives her the direct line, doesn't try to force a same-day decision.

Debrief prompts. - Did the rep treat partner approval as an objection or a buying signal? - Did they book a *specific* next contact, or accept "I'll get back to you"? - Did they leave Karina feeling rushed, or feeling looked after?

Scenario 5B — Habit drift investigation

Difficulty: Hard · **Run time:** ~10 min · **Reps required:** 1 (operator alone)

The setup. You're a senior rep in your operator role. Last week was rough — closing rate down, energy off, two prospects who said "let me think" without giving you a real diagnostic moment. You feel the drift but can't name the cause.

The mood. Honest self-investigation. No defensiveness.

Where you are now. Sitting with a notebook, ready to actually do the work.

The rep's job. Session 05 — habit drift investigation. Compare this week to your strongest month. Ask three questions:

1. *What daily habit was I running at my peak that I'm not running now?*
2. *What feels GOOD right now that might be the feel-good inversion at work?*
3. *What's the ONE specific habit I'm reinstating tomorrow?*

Write answers — not bullet points, full sentences. No more than 5 lines per question.

What to expect from yourself. - Brain will offer comforting answers ("nothing's really changed") - Honest answer will usually be one of: skipped pre-meeting prep, started taking calls without the 3-question opener, dropped the daily drilling, stopped reviewing call notes - Feel-good signal will often be "I've been getting through admin faster" or "I've been more relaxed" — both decoys

Success looks like. Three honest answers. One specific habit identified. Reinstall plan dated for tomorrow morning.

Debrief prompts. - Was the brain offering comfort answers, or honest ones? - Is the identified habit actually a habit, or a vague aspiration? - Is the reinstall plan time-specific (e.g. "7:15am Monday")?

Session 06 — Use the Checklist, Connection Beats Technique

Scenario 6A — Booked-solid follow-up call (the meeting you booked from rp-06)

Difficulty: Intermediate · **Run time:** ~15 min

The prospect. Sam Kovacs (same Sam from the original cold call roleplay). Owns *Kovacs Electrical*. Booked solid 6 months out. You landed the 10-minute meeting from the cold call last week. Now you're in his office.

The mood. Mildly curious. He turned up to the meeting, which is a good signal — but he's still half-bracing for a leads pitch.

Where you are now. You've got 30 minutes. The first 10 minutes are about building connection without pitching. The second 10 are about applying the affordability formula visibly to demonstrate competence. The last 10 are when you decide whether to pitch or recommend a follow-up.

The rep's job. Session 06 + 07 — connection first, then competence demonstration, then pitch only if the temperature's right. Apply the trade-business affordability formula in real time on Sam's business so he can see your work. Use the "insurance against future downturn" frame established in the cold call.

What to expect from Sam. - He'll test you: "*So what's this actually going to cost me?*" in the first 5 minutes - Don't take the bait — redirect to questions about his business - He'll be impressed if you do the affordability maths out loud - He'll lean in when you reference the historical downturns (2009, 2020)

Success looks like. First 10 minutes are about Sam's business, not your product. Affordability calc happens between minute 10–20. Pitch (if it happens) lands in minutes 20–28. Rep doesn't take the early bait on pricing.

Debrief prompts. - Did the rep maintain the "this isn't about leads" frame from the cold call? - Did they get to affordability maths visibly, or skip it? - Did they pitch at the right time, or rush it?

Scenario 6B — Trade affordability formula, live

Difficulty: Easy · **Run time:** ~8 min · **Reps required:** 2 (driller + responder)

The setup. Pure technique drill — no roleplay context. Two reps quiz each other on the trade affordability formula. Speed and confidence are what's being trained.

The drill. Driller calls out a business description. Responder calls back the affordability number — out loud, within 5 seconds. No calculator.

Sample prompts (driller can invent more): - “Bricklayer, 4 staff” → ~\$1.2M ($\$100k \times 4 \times 3$) - “Electrician, 11 staff” → ~\$3.3M - “Plumber, 8 staff” → ~\$2.4M - “Painter, 6 staff” → ~\$1.8M - “Accountant, 6 staff” → ~\$600k (service business, NO $\times 3$ multiplier) - “Lawyer, 4 partners + 8 staff” → ~\$1.2M for staff; partners earn extra (depends on practice) - “Tiler with 5 staff” → ~\$1.5M - “Carpenter, 12 staff” → ~\$3.6M

The rep's job. Apply the formula reflexively: - **Trade** (physical work, vehicles, materials): $\text{staff} \times \$100k \times \sim 3$ - **Service** (professional, no inventory): $\text{staff} \times \$100k \times 1$ - Multiply prospect's self-reported number by ~2x as default

Success looks like. Each response within 5 seconds. Trade vs service distinction is automatic. No “uhh, let me think.”

Debrief prompts. - Where was the hesitation — on the multiplier, or on the staff number? - Did the rep apply the service formula to trades or vice versa? - Is the formula reflexive yet, or still effortful?

Session 07 — 80% Likable, 20% Technical, Always

Scenario 7A — Refreshing care with a long-term client

Difficulty: Intermediate · **Run time:** ~10 min

The client. Geoff Harrison. Owns *Harrison Plumbing*. Has been a Marketing Sweet client for 2 years and 4 months — paying \$1,400/month, results are steady, no complaints. You haven't actually called him with anything but renewal questions in 8 months.

The mood. Geoff will pick up. He likes you. But somewhere in the back of his head a quieter agency might already be making noises about a cheaper deal.

Where you are now. Phone in hand. The call has NO sales agenda. You're just calling to genuinely check in.

The rep's job. Session 07 — refresh care with long-term clients. The call must: - Open with a genuine reason that isn't a sales reason - Reference something specific you remember about his business - Ask about him as a person, not just the business - End without pitching anything - Last under 8 minutes

What to expect from Geoff. - Initially confused — “*Why are you calling? Did something happen?*” - Once he realises the call has no agenda, he opens up - Will mention something about his business or family — that's the gold - Might bring up a service question — handle if relevant, but don't pivot to upsell

Success looks like. Call ends warm. Geoff feels valued, not pitched. The rep has at least one new specific data point about Geoff's life or business that they didn't have an hour ago. No money was discussed.

Debrief prompts. - Did the call have a clear non-sales reason, or did it feel like a check-in disguised as nothing? - Did the rep ask about Geoff personally, not just professionally? - Did they resist pivoting to upsell when an opportunity came up?

Scenario 7B — Asymmetric question drill

Difficulty: Easy · **Run time:** ~8 min · **Reps required:** 2 (driller + responder)

The setup. Pure technique drill. Two reps quiz each other on rephrasing risky questions into asymmetric ones.

The drill. Driller reads a risky question. Responder rewrites it as an asymmetric question — out loud, within 10 seconds.

Sample prompts: - Risky: *“What’s your budget?”* → Asymmetric: *“Which of these three feels closest to where you want to be in 12 months?”* - Risky: *“Do you like our work?”* → Asymmetric: *“What’s stood out for you — and what would you change if you could?”* - Risky: *“What did you think of the budget changes?”* (landmine) → Asymmetric: *“Has the past 12 months been net helpful or net stressful for your industry?”* - Risky: *“Why haven’t you done this sooner?”* → Asymmetric: *“What’s kept this on the to-do list?”* - Risky: *“How much do you spend on marketing?”* → Asymmetric: *“Where does most of your new work come from at the moment — referrals, search, or repeat?”* - Risky: *“Do you trust agencies?”* → Asymmetric: *“What’s the one thing an agency would need to do for you to feel safe signing up?”* - Risky: *“How big do you want to grow?”* → Asymmetric: *“What size feels comfortable, and what size feels too far?”* - Risky: *“What’s wrong with your current website?”* → Asymmetric: *“If you had to point at one thing you wish your current site did better, what would it be?”*

The rep’s job. Rebuild every risky question into an asymmetric one — works regardless of how the prospect answers.

Success looks like. Each response within 10 seconds. The asymmetric versions feel natural in dialogue, not stilted.

Debrief prompts. - Which question type was hardest to rephrase? - Did any rephrasings feel like they’d still get a flat answer in real life? - One question to drill more tomorrow?

End of practice scenarios · 14 scenarios across 7 sessions · Run them in rotation, swap roles, debrief honestly.